

## RESIDENTIAL LIFE COUNCIL CONSTITUTION

We the resident students of Furman University, in order to build residential communities, promote and improve communication between the administration and students, and to provide imperative services for residential use, do hereby establish and adopt this constitution for the Residential Life Council.

### Article I Title

The Title of this organization shall be the Residential Life Council (RLC).

### Article II Constituency

The constituency of this organization shall consist of students who are currently attending Furman University and are living or have lived, for at least one academic year, in the residential areas on the campus of Furman University.

### Article III Functions

- SECTION 1. RLC shall act as the representative assembly for the residential student experience.
- SECTION 2. RLC Shall provide and administer activities that build residential communities.
- SECTION 3. RLC shall provide physical and social services necessary to promote the welfare and interests of residential students.
- SECTION 4. RLC shall serve as a liaison between the administration of Furman University, Housing and Residential Life, and the residential students.
- SECTION 5. RLC shall exercise the responsibility for the determination of all powers not delegated by this Constitution.

### Article IV Organization and Operation

- SECTION 1. Bodies
  - a. The primary body of RLC shall be the General Council, consisting of no more than 50 Representatives. It is essential that the General Council is representative every housing location (South Housing, Lakeside, North Village, The Vinings, and Bell Tower Cabins).
  - b. An Executive Council shall be chosen by the General Council from its members.
- SECTION 2. Meetings
  - a. RLC shall meet each week during the regular school year unless deemed unnecessary by Executive Council.
  - b. All meetings shall be conducted in general accordance with the guidelines provided by *Robert's Rules of Order, Newly Revised*.
  - c. A quorum for business shall consist of three-fifths (3/5) of the membership of RLC.

### Article V General Policy

- SECTION 1. Attendance
  - a. An RLC member may only acquire two (2) excused and one (1) unexcused absence from weekly council meetings each semester. Excused absence defined as a required Furman-sponsored event, medical conflict, or any excuse deemed valid by the executive council.
  - b. Unless extenuating circumstances exist, the Representative shall notify the Secretary of an absence 4 hours prior to the particular RLC event.



- c. After two (2) absences, a review of the Representative will take place by the Executive Council. For any member who exceeds their allotted number of absences, a probationary period will be placed on said member until they qualify as an active member of council.
- d. A leave of absence request must be presented to the Executive Council for approval. If approved, the leave of absence relieves the representative of all RLC responsibilities. A study abroad qualifies as a leave of absence.

#### SECTION 2.

##### General Requirements for RLC Membership

- a. Representatives must be full-time Furman students.
- b. Representatives are required to either live or have lived on campus for at least one year upon admittance into RLC.
- c. Each representative is required to attain four (4) points per term. Point defined as working an event shift.
- d. When attending an RLC-sponsored event, a Representative must be prepared to serve in an official capacity as a representative of RLC.
- e. If a Representative fails to meet the General Requirements, a review of the Representative will take place by the Executive Council.

#### Article VI

##### Applications and Elections

#### SECTION 1.

##### Applications

- a. Representatives to RLC will be chosen by means of an application and an interview conducted by no fewer than three (3) members of the Executive Council.
- b. Any Furman student may apply for RLC during any open application period (September & January). The deadline for the application will be decided by the Executive Council.

#### SECTION 2.

##### Elections

- a. Elections for Executive council members must take place in November, at a date to be specified by the current Executive council.
  1. Nominations for the particular office will be taken from the General Council.
  2. During the following council meeting, the elections will be held in the following order: President, Vice President, Secretary, Treasurer, Parliamentarian, Historian.
  3. Each candidate shall be allowed briefly to speak about their qualifications, and their current commitments. They shall then leave the room until voting is complete.
  4. A ballot vote will be taken, and if no candidate receives a majority, the winner will be determined in a runoff between the top two vote recipients.
- b. In the event of a vacancy on the Executive Council, nominations shall be taken from the General Council. The Executive Council has the power to hold immediate elections for this position as they see fit.

#### Article VII

##### Officers

#### SECTION 1.

##### The Executive Council shall:

- a. Consist of the President, the Vice President, the Secretary, the Treasurer, the Parliamentarian, and the Historian.
- b. Serve the term from the first meeting in January until the final meeting in December.
- c. Shall serve in a house as an ex officio member with the exception of President and Vice President.

#### SECTION 2.

##### The President shall:

- a. Preside over RLC functions, meetings, and activities.
- b. Preside over the Executive Council.
- c. Represent RLC in an official capacity.
- d. Serve as the chief liaison between RLC and other administrative bodies.
- e. Appoint each member of the Executive Council as a member of an RLC committee.



- f. Commit to an entire year of uninterrupted service on the Executive Council.

- SECTION 3. The Vice President shall:
- a. Preside over RLC in the absence of the President and otherwise assist the President in the execution of his/her duties.
  - b. Be responsible for house interaction and efficiency.
  - c. Be responsible for council motivational activities during meetings, retreats, and General Council socials.
  - d. Collaborate with the Historian for the recruitment of new members.

- SECTION 4. The Secretary shall:
- a. Keep in good order a record of each meeting's minutes and otherwise execute the function of clerk for RLC.
  - b. Take attendance and maintain the weekly agenda.
  - c. Keep track of attendance of and points served by all representatives of RLC including, but not limited to, council meetings and events.

- SECTION 5. The Treasurer shall:
- a. Keep in good order all financial records of RLC.
  - b. Prepare a financial report to be presented to the RLC advisor and the general council by the last meeting in March of each school year.
  - c. Keep the council informed of all financial matters.
  - d. Be the chairperson for the Finance Committee.
  - e. Meet with the RLC advisor once a month to discuss financial matters.
  - f. Present the RLC budget and spending guidelines to SGA annually.

- SECTION 6. The Parliamentarian shall:
- a. Maintain order in all meetings.
  - b. Have a clear understanding of Robert's Rules of Order and parliamentary procedure.
  - c. Ensure that Robert's Rules of Order are abided by in all meetings.
  - d. Act as the representative to SGA.
  - e. Submit events to SyncDin.

- SECTION 7. The Historian Shall
- a. Document RLC events.
  - b. Present RLC achievements at the end of the year.
  - c. Be responsible for or appoint a member of council to be in charge of the external methods of communication, such as Facebook, Twitter, Pinterest, blogs, and brochures.

- SECTION 8. All outgoing officers shall remain members of RLC in an advisory capacity for the remainder of the school year following their terms of office.

#### Article VIII Committees and Houses

- SECTION 1. Ad hoc committees may be formed at the discretion of the General Council.

- SECTION 2. There will be four (4) houses comprised of General Council and Executive Council.

- SECTION 3. Each house is responsible for planning and coordinating RLC sponsored events as approved by Executive Council.

- SECTION 4. The house responsibilities are as follows:
- 1. Provide services to the residential students at Furman University.
  - 2. Identify and assist with residents' concerns regarding maintenance of physical residential facilities by acting as a connector between residents and University Housing Staff.

3. See that all RLC rental equipment is functional and that repairs are done when needed.
4. Provide publicity for every RLC sponsored event in the form of posters, banners, advertisements, and online social networking sources.
5. Sponsor social events for the Furman community that enhance residential life.
6. Maintain an electronic forum for questions and concerns regarding Housing and Residential Life and the activities of RLC.
7. Seek out issues important to residential students and address them.
8. Be responsible for all RA and FRAD appreciation duties.

#### Article IX Monetary Procedures

- SECTION 1. Funds for the operation of RLC will be obtained from a percentage of the Student Activities Fee.
- SECTION 2. The budget must be approved by RLC before it takes effect.  
 a. The budget must specify how funds will be spent during the school year.  
 b. It must provide for the allocation of at least 80 percent of all estimated funds.
- SECTION 3. Funds may be spent outside of the budget only with the approval of RLC. And RLC Executive Council  
 a. Houses wishing to spend more than their allotted line item amount must submit a reallocation request to the treasurer in order to move necessary funds between line items.  
 b. Any single purchase or allocation over \$100 that is not specifically accounted for in the budget must be brought before council for an approval by majority vote.
- SECTION 4. The RLC fiscal year will begin August 1 and end July 31 each year.

#### Article X Removal of Members

- SECTION 1. In order to bring forth impeachment proceedings, there must exist reasonable cause as outlined by, but not limited to, the following:  
 a. Failure of a Representative to fulfill his/her duties as a Representative to RLC  
 b. Failure of a Representative to abide by the attendance policy.
- SECTION 2. Impeachment proceedings shall be conducted by RLC's Executive Board and presided over by the President (or by the next officer in order of succession, should the President be the representative in question)
- SECTION 3. Upon conviction, the offending representative shall be automatically removed from RLC. If necessary, appropriate election shall be conducted within two weeks of the removal to provide for his/her replacement.

#### Article XI Honoraria

- SECTION 1. There are to be six honoraria specifically assigned to each of the six RLC Executive Officers: President, Vice President, Secretary, Treasurer, Parliamentarian and Historian.
- SECTION 2. The amount for each honorarium shall be as follows:  
 President \$450.00  
 Vice President \$300.00



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|-----------------|----------|
| Secretary       | \$300.00 |
| Treasurer       | \$300.00 |
| Parliamentarian | \$150.00 |
| Historian       | \$150.00 |

SECTION 3. Half of each honoraria will be paid at the conclusion of each academic term.

SECTION 4. Honoraria will remain at the set amount unless altered by amendment. If honoraria are altered by amendment, alterations will not take effect until the beginning of the next executive council's term.

#### Article XII Amendments

SECTION 1. Amendments to this constitution must be introduced in a session of RLC by a member of the General Council or the Executive Board.

SECTION 2. A two-thirds ( $\frac{2}{3}$ ) vote by the membership of RLC is required to amend this constitution.

#### Article XIII Ratification

SECTION 1. This constitution shall be ratified by two-thirds ( $\frac{2}{3}$ ) vote cast by the membership of RLC.

SECTION 2. Following the ratification of this constitution of RLC, it must be submitted to SGA for approval.